What if Israel were an island? The facts

מה אם ישראל הייתה אי? העובדות

Episode 1 is a joke with real numbers inside. Here they are, plus what is opinion and what is fact.

פרק 1 הוא בדיחה עם מספרים אמיתיים בפנים. הנה הם, ומה דעה ומה עובדה.

The facts

העובדות

- **We already live on an island, by trade:** some 98% of Israel's foreign trade passes through sea ports (State Comptroller of Israel, 2020).
- **Land borders today:** 1,017 km in total, with Egypt, Gaza, Jordan, Lebanon, Syria and the West Bank (CIA World Factbook, via Jewish Virtual Library). The reel cuts the outer border of the whole land, so its number is smaller.
- **Travel:** you can't drive out of Israel for a weekend abroad the way Europeans do. Ben Gurion airport is the bridge.
- **Islands are not automatically peaceful:** Cyprus remains divided between Greek and Turkish Cypriots after the 1974 invasion.

In my view

לדעתי

- Water stops tanks, not rockets. 15 km of sea is nothing for a missile.
- Water doesn't make peace. Neighbors do.

> **Your turn:** would you move to Island Israel? Yes or no, and one reason. Episode 2 (we sail away) is on my profile.

תורכם: הייתם עוברים לאי ישראל? כן או לא, וסיבה אחת. פרק 2 מחכה בפרופיל.

Sources

מקורות

1. State Comptroller of Israel, Sea ports report (2020), 98% of foreign trade: https://library.mevaker.gov.il/sites/DigitalLibrary/Documents/2020/70a/EN/102-sea-ports-Taktzir-EN.pdf
2. CIA World Factbook: Israel, via Jewish Virtual Library: https://www.jewishvirtuallibrary.org/jsource/History/ciaisrael.html
3. The New Arab, Cyprus divided after Greeks, Turks mark invasion anniversary: https://www.newarab.com/news/cyprus-divided-after-greeks-turks-mark-invasion-anniversary